

Your Prime Spending Years

When I was visiting India, my uncle told me something I'll never forget: "Your prime spending years are between forty and sixty years old."

Think about that: What if you didn't just have to think about *saving* more, but you actually had to consider what and when to *spend* it? And the right answer wasn't just "later"?

You and I intuitively get this. We know that there are certain things that are better done now, and others later. I'm not rolling out to Everest Base Camp when I'm ninety.

But stop right there! Before reading on, don't make the mistake that so many people do. They defer their dreams until some day in the future, thinking of some magical moment when they'll have the time, money, physical health, and mental energy to fulfill it. The world's couches are filled with people who said, "I'll do that someday."

If you remember one thing from this journal, remember this: *Your Rich Life will never happen on its own.* Only you can make it happen—and I want you to make it happen soon.

It's true that you'll probably have more money in the future than now. But often, as your net worth goes up, your inclination and willingness to try new things goes down. Imagine being too old to spend your money. My uncle mentioned my grandfather. "If you gave him \$10 million now, what would he do with it? He doesn't need money. He's just happy being home with us."

This is a provocative idea: that we all have an optimal spending window. Spend too early and you'll run out of money. Wait too long and you won't be able to truly enjoy it. Do you want to turn seventy and realize you have millions of dollars, but lack the skills and desire to spend it?

This philosophy has profound consequences for us. If you're crafting your Rich Life now, and you know the sweet spot for spending is between forty and sixty years old, what would you do now? What would you do later?